

Chapter 86-1

Gu Yixue.

Liang Shi quietly murmured these three characters, finding them rather pleasant to the ear.

The person was just like her name—full of charm and allure.

However...

"Wait." Liang Shi called out to her, taking a tissue from her pocket and handing it over, pointing at her shoulder from a distance. "You should wipe that."

"Where?" Gu Yixue was startled.

Liang Shi pointed at her shoulder again—there were two black marks on it that looked like something had fallen there.

From this distance, she couldn't see clearly.

Gu Yixue pulled down her black spaghetti strap, and the slip dress instantly transformed into an off-shoulder evening gown. Liang Shi averted her eyes and didn't look.

Unexpectedly, Gu Yixue chuckled lightly, "This is a tattoo."

Liang Shi: "..."

From her angle, Gu Yixue was backlit. The woman had an enchantingly alluring face, and when she smiled faintly, those fox-like eyes lifted at the corners—the kind of beauty that would captivate you even if it wasn't your type.

Around her neck hung a silver necklace with blue diamonds, as if it contained an entire starry sky.

Only now did Liang Shi see clearly the marks on her shoulder—three crooked black lines.

One of them had been covered by her black strap.

It was quite rare for someone to get a black tattoo.

This time, Liang Shi had misjudged.

Liang Shi withdrew the tissue and apologized in a low voice, "Sorry, I saw wrong."

"No problem." Gu Yixue's accent carried a hint of the Beijing dialect¹, and her use of *erhua*² sounded very natural. For Liang Shi, who had once worked hard in the capital city, it was quite pleasant to hear.

After Gu Yixue pulled down the strap on her left shoulder, she pointed at the three marks and asked Liang Shi, "Do they look good?"

Liang Shi: "..."

After a moment of silence, Liang Shi gave a universal answer: "Not bad."

Gu Yixue smiled, restored the strap to its original position, and casually brushed her loose hair over, covering part of the marks.

"This is wind," Gu Yixue said with a smile. "The unpredictable wind."

Liang Shi was puzzled. "Then why is it black?"

Gu Yixue's brows furrowed slightly, then she curved her lips into a smile, looking quite bewitching. "Because I like black."

After saying this, she waved at her. "Liang Shi, right? I'll remember you. If fate brings us together again, I'll treat you to a meal. But right now, I really have to go."

Liang Shi smiled too. "Alright."

She didn't refuse this offer, nor did she tease her about it.

Because both of them knew they would probably never meet again.

Haizhou City was so big, and this was Liang Shi's first time coming to this place.

It would probably be the last time too.

Where would they possibly run into each other?

Still, this person was quite interesting.

Liang Shi rubbed the lighter in her hand, then took out her phone and instinctively searched for the name Gu Yixue. There was no information at all.

What a pity.

At first, Liang Shi had thought she was some celebrity.

With such beautiful poise, it was a waste not to play femme fatale³ roles.

Footnotes:

¹ **Beijing dialect (京腔, jīng qiāng):** A distinctive accent and speaking style associated with Beijing, China's capital city. It's often considered a prestigious or cultured way of speaking in Chinese culture.

² **Erhua (兒化音):** A phonological feature characteristic of Mandarin Chinese spoken in Beijing and northern China, where an "r" sound (represented by 兒) is added to the end of syllables. It gives speech a distinctive, sometimes considered more casual or authentic Beijing sound.

³ **Femme fatale (蛇蝎美人, shé xiē měi rén):** Literally translates to "snake and scorpion beauty" in Chinese—a term describing a dangerously attractive woman who uses her beauty to manipulate or harm others, similar to the Western concept of a femme fatale.

Chapter 86-2

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When Liang Shi returned to the private room, she once again played the role of an invisible person.

Tonight's main characters were Xu Qingzhu and Su Yao.

Xu Qingzhu didn't talk much, exchanging more glances with Su Yao than words. The atmosphere in the private room was warm and harmonious.

Su Meiqi occasionally came over to chat with her, but it was just small talk.

Sheng Yu came over and asked her, "What should I call you from now on?"

"Call me sister too." Liang Shi picked her up and fed her a sweet kernel of corn. "You'll have three sisters from now on. Are you happy?"

Sheng Yu frowned, thinking seriously. "But you're Zhou Caihong's mom's colleague. Shouldn't I call you auntie?"

Liang Shi: "..."

"But I'm your sister's wife," Liang Shi said. "So I'm of the same generation as your sister."

"Then what does Zhou Caihong call you?" Sheng Yu started comparing.

Liang Shi answered, "She calls me Sister Liang."

"But Liang Wenxuan from Class 3 calls you auntie¹," Sheng Yu said. "We're clearly the same age. Zhou Caihong is such an idiot!"

Liang Shi's mind went blank for a second—who was Liang Wenxuan?

Then she remembered it was Ling Dang's formal name.

Other children outside always used formal names, but Liang Shi had never known Ling Dang's formal name.

Liang Shi was amused by Sheng Yu's childish words, but she still answered her seriously. "You two are the same age, but you're of different generations. In the Liang family, I'm Liang Wenxuan's aunt, but to you, I'm your sister. Rainbow didn't call me wrong—she's just smarter."

"No." Sheng Yu bared her teeth at her. "Zhou Caihong is an idiot!"

"Why? Do you two have some grudge?" Liang Shi asked.

Sheng Yu nodded, then shook her head, then said huffily, "Last week she didn't do her craft homework, so she stepped on mine and ruined it."

"Huh?" Liang Shi was shocked. "Really or not?"

Sheng Yu nodded, seemingly displeased with her doubt. "Of course it's real! I never lie!"

Liang Shi felt there must be some misunderstanding, so she stroked Sheng Yu's head and coaxed her gently. "Did she step on your craft homework on purpose?"

Sheng Yu shook her head. "No, she apologized to me."

Liang Shi finally relaxed. "Then did you forgive her?"

"I told her I'd forgive her if she made me an identical one," Sheng Yu said proudly. "That one was made by my mom with her own hands. She couldn't possibly make it."

Liang Shi: "..."

"And then?" Liang Shi asked.

Sheng Yu huffed lightly. "Of course she couldn't make it, so that's why I said she's an idiot!"

Liang Shi felt helpless. "Mom is good at these things, so she made you a beautiful craft project. But Rainbow hasn't learned how to do it, so it's normal that she can't. Besides, Rainbow is only five years old, just like you. Isn't it a bit unfair to ask this of her?"

"Of course." Liang Shi immediately added, "I'm not saying your request is wrong. After all, she did ruin your craft homework, and it's perfectly reasonable for you to ask her to compensate you with an identical one. But you can't mock her just because she can't make it, right?"

Sheng Yu tilted her head and looked at her with wide, expectant eyes. "Whose side are you on anyway?"

Liang Shi: "...I'm on the side of reason."

"Then I won't let my sister be with you anymore." Sheng Yu huffed. "Hmph! You're just siding with Zhou Caihong."

She was about to jump down from Liang Shi's arms, but Liang Shi held her tight and lightly flicked her forehead with a curved finger. "I'm clearly siding with you."

Sheng Yu: "?"

She snorted coldly. "You're lying!"

Liang Shi rocked her in her arms. "Rainbow is the top student in your school. She could recite five hundred ancient poems at three years old and is already doing middle school physics problems now. The only thing she can't do is craft homework, and that's because she lost to a mom who's good at these things—yet you call her an idiot."

Sheng Yu frowned. "But she just couldn't make it."

"You couldn't make it either," Liang Shi said. "If you could, would you need your mom to do your craft homework?"

Sheng Yu: "..."

"If even Rainbow is an idiot, what does that make you?" Liang Shi teased her. "A little genius?"

Sheng Yu was completely confused by her logic. She covered her ears and said, "I'm not listening, I'm not listening. Anyway, I don't want my sister to be with you anymore."

Liang Shi felt helpless. "Your sister won't listen to you."

Sheng Yu glared at her. "She definitely will!"

After saying that, she jumped down from Liang Shi's arms and toddled over to find Xu Qingzhu on her short little legs.

Sheng Yu walked over and tugged at Xu Qingzhu's arm. Xu Qingzhu was chatting with Su Yao about the Sheng family's recent situation.

When Sheng Linlang was mentioned, Su Yao was also full of nostalgia, saying she hadn't seen her in a long time. They used to be very close, but she always forgot why she had lost her memory.

Su Yao also said that she herself was too fragile and couldn't get through those painful days, which led to Xu Qingzhu being raised by Sheng Linlang all along.

It was thanks to Sheng Linlang's care that Xu Qingzhu had grown up so well.

Hearing these words, Xu Qingzhu felt awful inside, but she only comforted Su Yao. "You've already been very strong. You're really amazing."

Just as she finished speaking, Sheng Yu tugged at Xu Qingzhu's arm and looked up at her with those grape-purple eyes.

Xu Qingzhu asked, "What's wrong?"

Sheng Yu hugged her arm and acted coquettishly, wanting to be held. Xu Qingzhu picked her up. "What do you want?"

Back then, she and Xu Qingya weren't far apart in age, and Xu Qingya had a lively personality. After experiencing the kidnapping incident, Xu Qingzhu had become very withdrawn, often not stepping out of her room for an entire day.

She didn't have much experience taking care of a younger sister.

Now, looking at Sheng Yu, she didn't know whether to be strict or gentle with her.

After all, this was a younger sister—different from Ling Dang, who was a generation below.

So in the end, Xu Qingzhu decided to follow her heart and interact naturally.

Sheng Yu wrapped her arms around her neck and leaned close to whisper in her ear, "Sister, that Sister Liang is bad. Can we not be friends with her anymore?"

Hearing this, Xu Qingzhu looked toward Liang Shi and saw her holding a cup of water, looking helpless.

Xu Qingzhu asked Sheng Yu what had happened. After understanding the whole story, Xu Qingzhu paused and said, "Sheng Yu, have you ever thought..."

Sheng Yu blinked at her, full of hope.

She only heard Xu Qingzhu say, "Maybe that sister was right?"

Xu Qingzhu stroked Sheng Yu's head. "If a little genius like Rainbow, who has a photographic memory, is called an idiot, then what should an ordinary, average little kid like you be called? A dummy?"

Sheng Yu: "..."

She opened her mouth wide, about to burst into tears, but Xu Qingzhu stuffed a piece of apple into her mouth. "No crying allowed."

Sheng Yu went to find her mom, feeling wronged, but Su Yao also agreed with Xu Qingzhu's point and asked her in confusion, "Why do you keep targeting little Zhou Caihong?"

Sheng Yu said, "Because she's annoying!"

"It's because she knows more than you," Su Yao said. "She stole your spotlight, didn't she?"

Sheng Yu: "..."

Poor little Sheng Yu couldn't find any allies and only gained a bunch of "enemies."

She ran to a corner and sulked facing the wall.

Everyone burst into laughter at her antics.

In the end, it was Liang Shi who said she'd take her to play in the hallway that cheered her up again.

Footnotes:

¹ **Auntie (姑姑, gūgu):** In Chinese kinship terms, this specifically refers to one's father's sister. The complexity here arises because Chinese has very specific terms for relatives based on both generation and which side of the family they're from. Rainbow (Zhou Caihong) correctly calls Liang Shi "Sister Liang" because of their social relationship, while Ling Dang (Liang Wenxuan) calls her "auntie" because Liang Shi is actually her aunt by blood relation in the Liang family. Sheng Yu, being five years old, is confused by why two children of the same age would use different titles for the same person.

Chapter 86-3

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At the family reunion banquet, Liang Shi drank a bit of wine and toasted Su Zhe and Meng Tong.

Afterward, Xu Qingzhu also introduced her to Su Yao. Looking at Liang Shi, Su Yao praised, "She's a good child."

Then she was about to give her a card. Liang Shi originally wanted to refuse, but seeing Su Yao's expectant eyes, she accepted the card and sweetly called out "Mom."

Su Yao said happily, "Now I have three daughters."

Liang Shi kept everyone good company. When they came out of the restaurant, she and Xu Qingzhu stood at the entrance to see off the Su family. Only Su Nan remained in the end, saying he needed to return to school soon.

This younger brother was studying at the medical university, which was on their way.

Xu Qingzhu said she would drive him there later.

Su Nan, who had been silent all evening, said he could take a taxi there, but Su Zhe glared at him. "Your sister says she'll take you, so listen to her."

He probably wanted them to build some rapport.

After all the Su family members had left, Xu Qingzhu finally asked Su Nan, her voice slightly cold, "Are you heading back to the medical university later?"

Su Nan nodded.

After a moment, he added, "Yeah, I have an early class tomorrow."

"What major?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Su Nan said, "Clinical medicine."

"That takes many years of study," Xu Qingzhu said. "Five years, I think?"

"I'm in the eight-year combined bachelor's, master's, and doctoral program," Su Nan said.

You could tell this high level of education made him proud—even his tone lifted at the end.

Xu Qingzhu nodded. "That's pretty good. I have a friend who also graduated from the medical university."

Su Nan said "oh," then asked Xu Qingzhu, "What about you?"

Xu Qingzhu paused briefly. "Qingyi University."

As soon as these four characters came out, Su Nan's expression changed. He suddenly said, "I heard your dad was a genius."

Xu Qingzhu glanced sideways. "Hm?"

"A genius architect," Su Nan said. "So you inherited your IQ from your dad?"

Xu Qingzhu shrugged. "Maybe. But my mom's IQ is pretty high too. When it comes to artistic talent, no one can compare to her."

"Indeed." Su Nan nodded and said with a hint of admiration, "Auntie¹ is amazing."

After exchanging a few words, Xu Qingzhu and Su Nan had broken the ice.

However, Su Nan really was a man of few words. Su Meiqi had mentioned before that her brother's share of words had probably all been used up by her, so her brother was a complete introvert².

Xu Qingzhu hadn't planned on building a close relationship with Su Nan anyway—as long as they didn't become enemies, it was fine.

They hadn't grown up together after all, and being only nominally cousins, they certainly wouldn't be very close.

However, they had all added each other on WeChat at the dinner table. Su Nan's Moments³ was completely blank.

They first dropped Su Nan off at the medical university, then headed back to their neighborhood. The distance really was close.

Every time this happened, Liang Shi would sigh that Zhao Xuning really had great investment sense. Compared to her, the original owner's business acumen was far inferior!

After returning home, both of them were tired. After washing up, they each went back to their rooms to rest.

Footnotes:

¹ **Auntie (姑姑, gūgu):** Here Su Nan is referring to Su Yao (his aunt, his father's sister) when he says "Auntie is amazing," praising her artistic talents.

² **Introvert (悶葫蘆, mèn húlu):** Literally "a stuffy gourd." This is a Chinese idiom used to describe someone who is very quiet and keeps their thoughts to themselves, similar to calling someone a "closed book" or an introvert in English.

³ **Moments (朋友圈, péngyou quān):** WeChat's social media feature similar to Facebook's timeline or Instagram's feed, where users can post photos, videos, and status updates visible to their contacts.

Chapter 86-4

Before lying in bed, Liang Shi was still wondering if she would have trouble sleeping in an unfamiliar bed¹.

But the moment she lay down, she knew she wouldn't.

This mattress was so soft—soft enough that she could bury her head in the blanket and fall asleep immediately.

It might also be because she had been exhausted these past two days.

Just as she was nestled in bed, drowsy and about to fall asleep, that familiar eerie electronic voice suddenly sounded in her mind:

【Ding dong! Congratulations to the Host for completing Side Mission 1: Go on a three-day, two-night trip with Xu Qingzhu. The mission reward is 3 Luck Points or 300,000 RMB. Please make your selection.】

【Also, a friendly reminder: After 80 Luck Points, the difficulty of accumulating Luck Points doubles. If you cannot trigger key information, it will be difficult to accumulate Luck Points to 100. Please choose your mission reward carefully. Within ten minutes of the Host's selection, the mission reward will be deposited into the Host's account.】

After hesitating, Liang Shi chose the 300,000 yuan.

There was still half the time left until the mission ended, so accumulating 20 Luck Points shouldn't be difficult.

Besides, the system had already reminded her during the last announcement that she had accumulated 87 Luck Points, so only 13 remained.

Under these circumstances, she decisively chose the money.

【Alright, the mission reward will be deposited into the Host's account within ten minutes. Please check for receipt!】

However...

"Did you make a calculation error? Strictly speaking, we didn't go on a three-day, two-night trip. At most, it was two days and two nights," Liang Shi asked hesitantly.

System: 【...】

The system's moment of silence made Liang Shi feel like the other party was cursing her for being an idiot.

After all, it had already announced completion—why did she have to expose the issue?

Liang Shi regretted it the second after she asked. Her mouth was just a bit faster than her brain.

Mainly because she had also thought about this mission on the way back from the suburbs. At the time, she felt it probably wouldn't be completed, and she was already planning the next trip in her mind.

A moment later, the System answered: 【I hate that you're such a blockhead!】

Liang Shi: "?"

If this were a person, Liang Shi could understand and accept it quite well.

But the other party was an AI—an emotionless AI!

The System still had that eerie mechanical voice, and when it said the word "blockhead," there was a sudden burst of static—crackling and sizzling.

It hurt to listen to and made the statement even less credible.

System: 【Is the important part of a three-day, two-night trip the three days? No! It's the two nights! During two romantic nights, you two snuggled together intimately, sitting by the bonfire, standing by the sea. What matters isn't where you are, but that there are two people! A more intimate space nurtures the little sparks of ambiguity between two people, so this mission counts as completed.】

Liang Shi: "But at home, it's also a two-person space."

System: 【...】

【Ding dong! Because the Host is too dense, Little Tong² will bestow upon the Host a new title: Romance Killer.】

Liang Shi: "?"

"Is this title useful?" Liang Shi asked.

System: 【It's convenient for me to mock you!】

Liang Shi: "..."

Get lost.

Liang Shi's head hurt. She had made a mistake and was now being mocked by an AI as a Romance Killer?

No, she refused to accept this.

But the System did something even more despicable.

A few seconds later, the System's mechanical voice sounded again: 【Since the Host pointed out that the mission was not fully completed, the reward for this mission has been changed to 200,000 yuan, distributed according to the actual time spent. The reward will be deposited into the Host's account within ten minutes. Please check for receipt.】

Liang Shi: "?"

System: 【Honesty is a virtue praised by all of humanity. We hope the Host continues to maintain this quality.】

Liang Shi: "..."

"So will you reward me for my honesty?" Liang Shi asked with a hint of despair.

The System answered with certainty: 【No, but we will praise you. Host, you're so awesome! This is the first time I've seen such an honest Host. It's truly moving! Thank you for considering the Grudge Management Bureau's financial situation. All the employees will be grateful to you.】

Liang Shi: "..."

She felt that sentence was equivalent to: This is the first time I've seen someone so stupid. You actually considered other people's budget issues while forgetting that you're still broke yourself.

Liang Shi sighed, regretting it immensely. She didn't want to talk to the System anymore.

System: 【Oh no! The Host has already started to dislike Little Tong, but Little Tong still wants to continue serving the Host. Ying ying ying³.】

Liang Shi: "..."

This System was still as chatty as ever.

System: 【What did Little Tong do wrong? I just wanted to talk a bit more with the Host. After all, the Host is completing missions so quickly and well—you'll probably reach 100 Luck Points soon. While I'm happy for the Host, Little Tong is also secretly grieving.】

Liang Shi couldn't take it anymore and said coldly, "Get to the point."

System: 【...】

【Ding dong ding dong! Congratulations to the Host for completing the bonus task of the hidden mission: Help Xu Qingzhu reunite with her parents! The bonus task reward is 500,000 yuan and will be deposited into the Host's account within ten minutes. Please check for receipt!】

【Little Tong has really turned into a sour lemon⁴! The Host's 3S-rank lucky constitution really lets you become a salted fish⁵ and win while lying down. I'd like to interview the Host—is it fun being a lucky salted fish?】

Liang Shi: "..."

It was indeed fun, but she wasn't going to say it.

This mission reward was basically a freebie, and she had received the full reward amount.

¹ **Trouble sleeping in an unfamiliar bed (認床, rèn chuáng):** A Chinese expression meaning to have difficulty sleeping when not in one's own bed. Some people are said to "recognize" only their own bed and have trouble falling asleep elsewhere.

² **Little Tong (小統, xiǎo tǒng):** The System's cute nickname for itself, derived from "系統" (xìtǒng, meaning "system"). It uses this name when speaking in a cutesy or whiny manner.

³ **Ying ying ying (嚶嚶嚶):** An onomatopoeia representing cute crying or whimpering sounds, often used in Chinese internet culture to express being pitiful or seeking sympathy in an exaggerated, cutesy way.

⁴ **Sour lemon (檸檬精, níngméng jīng):** Chinese internet slang meaning someone who is jealous or envious. Similar to saying "I'm so sour/jealous" in English. The term literally means "lemon spirit/essence."

⁵ **Salted fish (鹹魚, xián yú):** Chinese slang for someone who lies around doing nothing, lacking ambition or motivation—like a dead, preserved fish. "Lying down and winning" (躺贏) refers to achieving success without putting in effort.

Chapter 86-5

Liang Shi asked impatiently, "Is there anything else? If not, I'm going to sleep."

System: 【...】

【As expected, is Little Tong destined to be disliked? But Little Tong really wants to chat with the Host a bit longer. As an outstanding Host representative, do you have anything you'd like to say?】

Liang Shi: "?"

Thank the System?

Impossible.

Liang Shi said with a cold expression, "Nothing to say."

System: 【...Alright, Little Tong is going to be so sad tonight that I won't be able to sleep. Wuwuwu.】

Liang Shi: "Enough. There's really no need to be so dramatic."

System: 【Hmph! You don't understand other people's little sentiments at all. I really don't know how you managed to progress through the missions so quickly.】

Liang Shi: "..."

Just as Liang Shi was about to forcibly exit, that familiar mechanical voice became serious.

【Ding dong! Congratulations to the Host for reaching 90 Luck Points. Dual Side Missions unlocked.】

【Side Mission 1 (C-Rank): Prepare a romantic candlelit dinner for Xu Qingzhu. It is said that with the enhancement of a candlelit dinner, the feelings between two people will warm up. If you add a bottle of aged red wine along with elegant cello or piano accompaniment, you will definitely spend a romantic evening together. The reward for this mission is 20,000 RMB. Time limit: three days.】

【Side Mission 2 (S-Rank): Spend 24 hours inseparable from Xu Qingzhu. When you're inseparable, there's so much you can do! It will definitely close the physical distance between you two, thereby creating a closeness of hearts. This side mission contains two key trigger points: A. Watch a horror movie with Xu Qingzhu or go to an escape room together. Love blossoms more easily in dark and scary environments. Facing the siege of NPCs can create natural and effective physical contact—a great opportunity for the Host's heart to pound! B. Coax Xu Qingzhu to sleep. Whether it's singing or telling stories, it will make the capture target's favorability toward you skyrocket. No one can resist a lover who tells them bedtime stories.】

【Only by triggering both key points A and B will Side Mission 2 be considered effectively completed. The mission reward is 200,000 yuan. Time limit: one week.】

【The side missions released this time can all be abandoned within 24 hours before the mission ends. Abandonment will not deduct Luck Points, nor will it accumulate Misfortune Points (continuing to mutter quietly, we are still currently in the Misfortune Points offline period). If you do not choose to abandon, it will be considered that the Host is confident in completing the mission. Overdue missions will deduct 1 and 5 Luck Points respectively. Please take the missions seriously and work hard to complete them.】

【PS: Dual side missions are added according to the Host's request. The Host can choose to accept them on their own. Once accepted, they must be completed. Failure to complete will deduct 10 Luck Points. Please choose carefully.】

【Another PS: The Luck Points deducted for overdue missions and failure to complete side missions do not stack. The highest deduction will be selected. We hope the Host won't hand over the Luck Points earned through hard work to others.】

【The above mission broadcast is complete. A warm reminder again: after 80 Luck Points, it will become a ten-tier broadcast system, and the difficulty of accumulating Luck Points will increase. Please complete your Luck Point accumulation as soon as possible.】

【Ding ling ling! The Host's current Luck Points are 96, and Misfortune Points are 0. However, because the Host used illegal means to gain the capture target's favorability, 6 Luck Points will be deducted and 10 Misfortune Points will be added. After settlement, the Host's current Luck Points are 90, and Misfortune Points are 0.】

【PS: The illegal means mentioned here refer to mentioning things from another world to the capture target to gain trust. You did well—don't do it again next time.】

【Another PS: The System is an existence that cannot be spoken of. Even after the System disappears, the Host still cannot mention anything related to the System to anyone. The Grudge Management Bureau is an existence that cannot be known by the masses. We exist outside the universe.】

【Yet another PS: To reach 100 Luck Points, you must trigger a key ■■■ event¹. Please use your clever little head, Host.】

Liang Shi: "..."

She had to admit, the System's sudden massive output made her head spin a bit, especially since she was already a bit sleepy.

But she roughly understood what it was saying.

Having coexisted peacefully with this System for so long, she could generally extract the important content from the System's nonsense.

She just didn't know what this key event the System mentioned was, or what conditions needed to be met to trigger it.

However...

"If my body comes over, and I tell Xu Qingzhu about what happened to me over there, will there be any problems?" Liang Shi asked.

System: 【No.】

【As long as you don't mention the System's existence, you can tell her.】

After saying this, the System added eerily: 【As long as you're not afraid of being caught by a national secret agency for dissection and research.】

Liang Shi: "?"

Was it her imagination?

It felt like this AI was threatening her.

System: 【How could that be? Little Tong is just worried about Little Tong's safety. There's absolutely no intention to threaten the Host. Blinking eyes.jpg】

Liang Shi couldn't be bothered to listen to it laboriously imitating humans. After a pause, she asked, "If my body also comes to this world, what about this current body? Will it be destroyed?"

The System fell silent.

Liang Shi continued to ask, "If you erase all traces of my existence in that world, what about the original owner? Will she have to stay in the interstellar prison forever?"

System: 【After your body comes to this world, the current body will be returned to the other Liang Shi. If her danger coefficient decreases, the System will release her from prison based on the test results and randomly find a world for her to continue living in.】

Liang Shi hesitated. "I originally came from this world. So which one is actually my body? Did we swap before, or did I simply stay here for a while?"

After asking, Liang Shi then inquired, "Can you tell me?"

System: 【...】

After a long time, the System answered: 【From your birth, you have been using your own body. But essentially, there is no difference between your two bodies. You are two people from parallel timelines who developed different thoughts due to living in different environments. Your DNA is the same. That is to say, when your body comes here, no detection equipment will discover that you've changed people. We need to ensure the safety of your existence.】

Liang Shi: "?"

She was even more surprised. "Our parents are different, so why would our DNA be exactly the same?"

System: 【It will change in specific environments.】

Tonight's System was practically possessed by an angel, answering every question.

Liang Shi pondered its words. "So you're saying that even if I bring my body here, my DNA will become the same as hers was before. And if she takes her current body back to my original world, her DNA will become the same as my original DNA."

System: 【Theoretically speaking, yes.】

Liang Shi: "..."

After a moment, Liang Shi asked, "Is there really no other way to let her use my body to return to the other world?"

She asked carefully, with a hint of hesitation.

System: 【...Tell me, what is your reason for insisting on this?】

Liang Shi let out a soft breath. "If I originally belonged to this world and our lives before the age of eight were swapped, then she should be the Liang Shi from the other world. I remember Grandma once told me, 'If only your mom and dad could see you like this'—that means my personality had undergone a huge change from before. In other words, the grandpa and grandma who accompanied me growing up should have originally been her grandpa and grandma. Because I became her, I received so much love. And because she became me, she suffered so much torment."

"There's no reason to let me return to my original position now while locking her up in prison," Liang Shi said. "If anyone should be locked up, shouldn't I be locked up too? I also took the life that belonged to her. I also took the love that belonged to her."

System: 【...】

A long and dreadful silence.

After the silence, Liang Shi said solemnly again, "I know it's dangerous for me to try to convince you to release a 3S-rank criminal, and it puts you in a difficult position. But I hope to know a solution—consider it me returning her life to her."

Most importantly, repaying the debt of gratitude to Grandpa and Grandma.

Footnotes:

¹ **Key ■■■ event:** The "□□" symbols in the original text represent censored or redacted characters, likely the word "事件" (shìjiàn, meaning "event"). This is a common occurrence in Chinese web novels where certain words are automatically censored by the publishing platform, or the author deliberately obscures information to create suspense.